

World Café @ Cologne

Session results in English: what participants said about human-centered AI, and what they voted most important.

// SESSION

September 18, 2026 · Cologne

13 participants, including 2 facilitators.

SESSION DETAILS

FACILITATORS	Prof Karen Eilers and Bernd Joussen
DATE	September 18, 2026
PARTICIPANTS	13 (including 2 facilitators)
INFORMED CONSENT	From all participants (available at Lucid Institute)
TRANSCRIPTION	Claude AI (verified by Karen Eilers)
ANONYMIZATION	By Karen Eilers

NOTES

Stations 2 and 3 were skipped due to fewer than 15 participants (as per the guide). Only stations 1, 4 and 5 were run.

- **Station 2:** *"How has AI been used in your organization in a manner that improved the work experience or work enjoyment of employees?"*
- **Station 3:** *"What are examples in your organization where the use of AI was not human-centered, or where could you see it easily sliding down that path?"*

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reflexiveai.org · info@reflexiveai.org

OPENING EXERCISE

Impromptu Networking

“What does human-centered AI look like for you? How does this relate to your work or this organization?”

#	RESPONSE
1	Your own synthesis is important
2	AI = tool. Does not replace people
3	<i>Drawing:</i> a person in the center (lightbulb above) surrounded by three “TOOL” bubbles with arrows to and from the person; labelled “Human in the loop”, plus a padlock labelled “Save” (safe).
4	<i>Drawing:</i> split panel. Left: “AI 4 ALL” – one LLM for everything. Right: three numbered circles – “Context-bound” (several specialized AIs).
5	Providing curated, context- and application-specific AI tools instead of general/generic tools
6	“safe” / “secure”
7	“ethical”
8	supportive
9	Creating space for the human element
10	No replacement, only a complement
11	Not too strongly personified (anthropomorphized)
12	Accompaniment – having someone by your side
13	Infrastructure
14	AI as a tool. The boundary to humanity blurs through “manners” (social etiquette when interacting with it)

STATION 1

What human-centered AI looks like

“What should human-centered AI look like in your organization? What results or outcomes would you see?”

#	RESPONSE	VOTES
6	E.g., in nursing/care, AI should take over administrative tasks so that people can take care of people <i>(example for “AI should accompany people”)</i>	6
1	AI is there for people, not people for AI	5
2	People must be professionally competent enough to evaluate AI output	4
7	People should be happier/relieved of burdens	4
8	People are physically safer	3
9	People are allowed to learn at a human pace	3
3	AI should accompany people	2
11	People feel pressure to engage with AI	2
5	E.g., a designer is best placed to evaluate the output of a design agent <i>(example for “People must be professionally competent...”)</i>	1
4	AI should accompany/support people within the scope of its capabilities	0
10	2 extremes: (1) excessive fear, (2) overflowing/excessive enthusiasm. Notes attached: “Shadow?” and “Light?”	0

Sorted by dot votes, highest first. “#” is the original position on the sheet; ties keep sheet order.

STATION 4

Rules & procedures

“What procedures, rules or processes should be implemented to ensure human-centered AI in your organization?”

#	RESPONSE	VOTES
7	The human remains accountable	7
4	AI Accountability Framework: ensuring that agents and (semi-)autonomous AI systems do not act in an uncontrolled way	5
8	For well-founded review of the output, sources and solution path/reasoning should be checked	5
1	All processes, rules and procedures must be decided by people (an “AI council”)	4
2	There must be a definition of “human-centered AI”	4
9	People who use AI must have completed a basic training	4
6	Use of AI tools tied to one's own competence: the more I can do myself, the more powerful my AI is allowed to be	1
3	AI creates new responsibilities that are to be taken on by people. (E.g., no agent may autonomously push deployments for self-driving cars.)	0
5	Four-eyes principle for AI output: no AI-generated output may be processed further without human review	0
10	When using language models, local, regional and cultural particularities (in the output) should be taken into account/ensured	0
11	When using LLMs, attention should be paid to choosing a model/tool appropriate to the task	0

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STATION 5

Measurement & auditing

“What could be measured, tracked or audited to ensure that the way your organization uses AI is human-centered?”

#	RESPONSE	VOTES
3	Criteria are Asimov's laws: harm avoidance, obedience, self-protection	6
5	Auditing: what does human-centered AI mean ⇒ shared understanding in the organization	5
13	Measure psychological safety in relation to working with AI: How safe do you feel sharing personal data with the AI?	4
17	What percentage of the time can an employee pursue the core of their work? E.g., how much time does the nurse have to care for patients?	4
11	Metric for the freedom/free space and creativity that arise through human-centered AI	3
9	Employee satisfaction: How satisfied are you with our AI (the way we use AI)? Would you work in this organization again, the way it uses AI? Also conceivable as customer satisfaction	2
10	Accountability framework: which agent is responsible for which task/process, and who is responsible for the agent (a human!)?	1
14	Better quality; more time for creativity; change in lead/turnaround times. Label work (tickets) processed with AI. Measure the company's innovation capability	1
15	How many fewer workplace accidents have occurred thanks to AI?	1
16	Data protection and information security: agree on the recording of meetings and don't pressure others	1
18	Work vs. employment/occupation	1
1	Aligned with the EU AI Act or comparable national commitments	0
2	<i>Drawing:</i> a boxy robot with antennae, arms and legs. "I will never look like this again!"	0
4	What feedback do I get from the AI?	0
6	Scanning for "inhuman" actions by the AI, and also for nonsense	0
7	Tracking "patterns" to recognize whether AI is still working in a human-centered way	0
8	Deriving goals ⇒ deriving metrics & key figures	0
12	Record reasons for leaving and track how often "was replaced by AI" comes up	0

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ACTION

15% Solutions

Actions participants can take without extra permission or resources.

#	RESPONSE
1	PROMOTE / ADVOCATE for human-centered work models
2	Bring the concept of human-centered AI into the discourse of the org units. Become an HC-AI ambassador.
3	Consistently outsource routine tasks to AI and use the freed-up time for creativity and exchange
4	Show empathy for colleagues
5	I – not the AI – decide whether the problem has been solved
6	Share my experiences with AI; give space for exchange
7	Be open to new things
8	I can discuss the results of the evening with IT's AI "officer/representative"
9	I only use AI tools approved by my company
10	Share knowledge
11	Continue learning with/about AI
12	Four-eyes principle with the AI; risk analysis
13	Leadership (<i>category label for the next item</i>)
14	General check on whether the use of this AI is still within the target corridor